

Writing

1. How to write an essay

1.1 Structure on an essay

Introduction

The introduction presents the topic and sets the tone for the essay. It may provide some background information and should include a clear thesis statement—the central idea or argument that the essay will develop.

Body

The body is composed of one or more paragraphs, each focusing on a single main point. These paragraphs develop the thesis through explanations, evidence, and examples. Each paragraph should begin with a topic sentence and be logically connected to the others.

Conclusion

The conclusion summarizes the key points and restates the main idea in a different way. It may also offer a final reflection or suggest broader implications. No new information should be introduced in the conclusion.

1.2 Linking words and phrases

Linking words are essential for creating cohesion and clarity in your writing. They help guide the reader through your argument or explanation.

- **To add information:** also, in addition, furthermore, moreover
- **To give examples:** for example, for instance, such as, in particular
- **To contrast ideas:** however, although, but, on one hand, on the other hand, nevertheless
- **To show cause and effect:** because, so, therefore, as a result, thus
- **To organize points or sequence:** first, second, third, then, next, finally
- **To conclude:** in conclusion, in short, in a nutshell, to sum up

1.3 Tips for Writing a Good Essay

1. Plan before writing: Think about your main ideas and how they connect.
2. Stick to the topic: Make sure every paragraph supports your thesis.
3. Use clear topic sentences: Begin each paragraph with its main idea.
4. Be concise and focused: Avoid repeating the same ideas or using unnecessary words.
5. Vary your sentence structure: Combine short and long sentences for better rhythm.
6. Revise and edit: Check grammar, punctuation, and the flow of your ideas. Read your essay aloud if possible.

1.4 Example

Topic: Why it's important to have hobbies

Many people have hobbies such as playing sports, reading books, or learning new skills. In my opinion, having a hobby is very important because it helps us relax, learn new things, and enjoy our free time.

First of all, hobbies help people relax and reduce stress. After a long day of work or school, doing something you enjoy can help you feel better. For example, when I play the guitar, I forget about my problems and feel more peaceful.

Second, hobbies allow us to learn new skills. Whether it's cooking, painting, or playing chess, hobbies make us more creative and help us discover new interests. In my case, I started learning photography during the pandemic, and now it's one of my favourite activities.

Finally, hobbies can also help us connect with others. Many people join clubs or groups where they meet others who share the same passion. This creates friendships and a sense of community.

In conclusion, hobbies are an important part of life. They help us relax, grow as people, and enjoy meaningful time alone or with others. Everyone should try to find a hobby they love.

Shall we practise?

Write an essay about how technology helps us in daily life. Your essay should be between 120 and 150 words.

Remember to include:

- ✓ An introduction to the topic
- ✓ At least two ways technology helps us (with examples)
- ✓ A short conclusion with your personal opinion

Use connectors like first of all, for example, also, however, and in conclusion to organise your ideas.